I drove about quite a bit, following all orders and making no mistakes that I could see except for beginning to drive into a one-way street the wrong way when the tester deliberately ordered me to do so. He stopped me, of course, and told me roughly that I shouldn't follow illegal orders. He was quite right in that.

At the end, he asked me the ethnic nature of my name, and I said, "Russian." "Were you born there?" he wanted to know, and I said, "Yes," wondering if he were going to have the nerve to refuse me a license on that ground. After all, the North Koreans were still advancing quite rapidly into South Korea and it was doubtful, as yet, if the American forces pouring into the country could stop them. If the Soviets chose to join the North Koreans, World War III was around the corner.

But the tester just said, "Well, I hope the Russians drive tanks the way you drive this automobile."

So I managed a smile that served to convince the idiot I was congratulating him on the subtlety and sophistication of his sense of humor, and he passed me.

I had my first driver's license!

It meant that Gertrude could relax. Since I had a license, and since I liked to drive, I could drive for both until she felt like taking lessons again.

What I didn't have, though, was a car. I was still waiting for it to arrive at the dealers from whom we were purchasing it, and the dealer was talking dolefully about delays because of the war in Korea.

While waiting, I mailed off "Potent Stuff" to Horace Gold, and Gertrude finally decided where we would go for a vacation that year. It would be to Camp Annisquam, on the seashore, this time—at Cape Ann in Massachusetts, to be specific. Two weeks again and this time it would be in the shank of the season—last week of July and first week of August.

We began packing on July 22 (our first anniversary in the Somer-ville apartment), and on that day my very first Doubleday statement

and royalty check arrived. Such statements have been a semi-annual feature of my life ever since.